MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

Cloud Infrastructure & DevOps | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral environments and build/test infrastructure. Uses GitLab CI, Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes access at work; also builds and operates a personal k3s homelab using GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure. Experienced in improving pipeline performance and reliability, documenting technical processes, and working across QA, product and development teams. Transitioning from QA automation into cloud infrastructure and platform engineering, with hands-on experience in CI/CD, ephemeral Kubernetes environments, infrastructure automation, observability and Linux-based systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal Hetzner infrastructure project), Argo CD, GitOps, Git

Containers & Platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access at work), k3s, Linux

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Programming & Automation: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Ansible (basic), GitLab API

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, adding dependency caching and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments for application services, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed through GitLab CI using Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL pipeline-results workflow and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests and prioritise fixes.
- Write Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored the internal CI workflow guide used for team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

Personal Infrastructure Project — Homelab k3s Cluster and Hetzner VPS | *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.

- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered short-lived Helm environments via GitLab CI for QA and product reviews and end-to-end testing, with automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30% through parallel jobs, dependency caching and a separate end-to-end stage.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027 — not yet certified

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)